

1 Ground truth and the evaluators

Your embedding looks good. Is it correct?

- Procrustes-aligned RMSE against the true unfolding as the headline metric.
- Trustworthiness, continuity, kNN preservation, Kruskal stress — each measured *against* truth.
- Where each standard metric is optimistic, and by how much.
- The metrics are kNN-based and mutually correlated; exact truth is what makes the comparison possible.
- The book's main experimental contribution.